

Cybercrime Case Study: Phishing

Phishing is a cyber attack where users are tricked into sharing personal information through fake emails or websites. It is a type of cybercrime in which attackers try to steal sensitive information such as usernames, passwords, or banking details by pretending to be a trusted organization.

A common case involves a college student who receives an email that appears to be from their bank. The email looks official, with the bank's logo and formatting, and it warns the user that their account will be blocked if they do not verify their details immediately. The message includes a link that redirects the user to a fake website that looks almost identical to the real bank website.

Believing the message to be genuine, the student enters their login credentials and OTP on the fake website. Within minutes, the attacker gains access to the student's bank account and performs unauthorized transactions, resulting in financial loss.

These attacks usually target students and young users because they may not be fully aware of online threats. As a result, the attacker gains access to sensitive information, which can lead to financial loss, identity theft, or misuse of accounts. These attacks rely on urgency and fear to trick users into acting quickly without thinking.

Phishing attacks are increasing rapidly due to the widespread use of digital platforms. In many cases, victims realize the fraud only after the damage has already been done.

This case highlights the importance of being cautious while using digital platforms. Users should always verify email sources, check website URLs carefully, and avoid clicking on suspicious links to stay safe online. Awareness and careful behaviour are key to preventing such cybercrimes.